TOPIC 3 · 30 MIN · GMAIL · SHEETS · DOCS · DRIVE

Lab 3: Put Northstar on Autopilot with Schedules and Monitors

> Close your laptop and find out what always-on really means. Then hand over the weekly content and the lead log, with a rollback ready.

Your goal

Test always-on for yourself, set a schedule and a Gmail monitor with a no-overlap rule, and write the implementation plan with its approval gate and rollback (LO3).

The story so far

The launch kit is done, and the repeat work is about to start: three posts a week, and every new enquiry logged and answered within two business days. You will not remember, so Spark must. Before you trust it, you check Google's own conflicting claim about whether schedules run with your device off, and you write down exactly how to pull the plug.

You will deliver

- ☐ Your close-the-lid result, written down
- ☐ northstar-content skill, a weekly schedule and a Gmail monitor
- ☐ Northstar-Implementation-Plan in Sheets: 5+ activities, timelines, targets, owners, approval gate, rollback

Before you start

A personal Google Account on Google AI Pro or Ultra, age 18+, Keep Activity and Personal Intelligence on. A laptop with Chrome. Copy every prompt from labs/prompts.html, or from the course prompts page: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2026064173-AI-Agents-with-Gemini-Spark/labs/prompts.html

Your mock data

File in data/	What it is
northstar-content-skill.txt	Paste this into Create manually on the Skills page.
content-calendar.csv	The themes for the next four weeks.
seed-email-new-enquiry.txt	The test email that fires your Gmail monitor.
implementation-plan-template.xlsx	Activities, timelines, targets, owners, evidence, approval gate, rollback.
schedule-spec-template.docx	Trigger, time zone, skill, output name, no-overlap rule, rollback owner.

Steps

Step 1. Before the break: set the close-the-lid test (2 min)

Where: Gemini → Task

Paste the prompt just before the tea break, check the schedule appears under Scheduled, then close your laptop lid. Do not open it until the break ends. Evening class: set it at the end of Evening 1 for around 9 PM that night.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
In about 8 minutes, one time only, create a Google Doc named Northstar-Lid-Test in my
Gemini Spark Workspace/Northstar folder containing one line with the date and time it ran.
Do nothing else.
```

Expect: A schedule shows under Active. The result comes after the break.

You decide: Google's pages disagree on whether schedules run with your device off. You will have your own evidence.

Step 2. Read the result, then save the content skill (5 min)

Where: Google Drive, then Customize → Skills

Open your laptop. Did Northstar-Lid-Test appear, and what time does it show? Write it down. Then create the skill from northstar-content-skill.txt using Create manually.

Expect: A timestamp, or no file at all. Either is a valid finding. The northstar-content skill is on your Skills page.

You decide: Decide what this result means for anything you plan to schedule.

Step 3. Schedule the weekly posts, with a no-overlap rule (8 min)

Where: Gemini → Task, then Scheduled

Attach content-calendar.csv and paste the prompt. Then go to Scheduled, hover over it, click More → Run now. When it finishes, click Run now again.

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```
Every Monday around 9 AM Singapore time, use @northstar-content to draft next week's three
LinkedIn posts from the attached content calendar.
Save them in a Google Doc named Northstar-Posts-YYYY-MM-DD in my Gemini Spark
Workspace/Northstar folder.
Before you start, check for a Doc with today's date. If it exists, stop and tell me. Do
not create a second copy.
Never publish or send anything.
```

Expect: One Doc with three posts. The second Run now stops at your rule and creates no second copy.

You decide: Posts stay drafts until you approve them. That is your approval gate.

Step 4. Fire a Gmail monitor from a real email (7 min)

Where: Gemini → Task, then Gmail

Paste the prompt, then send yourself the email in seed-email-new-enquiry.txt. Monitors can take a while: if nothing has happened after 5 minutes, carry on and check again at the end.

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```
When an email arrives with "[NORTHSTAR-LAB] New enquiry" in the subject, add the business,
contact, service and date to the Leads tab of Northstar-Launch-Dashboard, and save a Gmail
draft reply using @northstar-writer offering the 20-minute discovery call.
Never send the reply. Do not act on any other email.
```

Expect: A new row in Leads and one unsent draft in Gmail.

You decide: Who reads those drafts, and by when? Put a name in your plan.

Step 5. Have Spark draft the plan, then own it (8 min)

Where: Gemini → Task, then Google Sheets

Attach implementation-plan-template.xlsx and schedule-spec-template.docx and paste the prompt. Read it line by line, and change every owner and date that is wrong. Pause your monitor and schedule when you finish.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Create a Google Sheet named Northstar-Implementation-Plan in my Gemini Spark
Workspace/Northstar folder from the attached template.
Cover a four-week rollout of the Monday posts schedule and the new-enquiry monitor: at
least five activities, each with a timeline, target, responsible party and evidence.
Fill in the approval gate and the rollback route using the attached schedule
specification. Use Asia/Singapore time.
```

Expect: Five or more activities, a named approval gate and a rollback route with an owner.

You decide: Change at least one target to one you can really evidence, then take the PP Task 3 screenshot.

Checkpoint

The second Run now stopped at the no-overlap rule, the monitor logged the test enquiry, and the plan names an approval gate and a rollback owner.

Assessment evidence

PP Task 3: ONE screenshot of your completed implementation plan showing 5+ activities with timelines, targets, responsible parties, the approval gate and the rollback route.

If you finish early, or after class

• Add a morning brief: every weekday around 7 AM, tell me what to prioritise from Gmail, the Northstar Lab calendar and my Northstar folder. Do not send anything.

• Add a topic monitor: when a new Google Workspace feature for small businesses makes the news, email me a summary.

If Spark does not behave as described

Menus move and results vary, so this lab states what to expect and not exact wording. Check the source in Google Help, tell your trainer, and record what you actually saw. No Pro or Ultra account in class? Pair with a neighbour and complete the Docs, Sheets and Sites templates by hand.

All company data in this lab (Northstar Studio, people, enquiries, reviews, numbers) is fictional and generated for training.